



Intersectionality in Games

The Importance of Feeling Safe, Seen and Understood





- Hallow
- you might not know me (i am old)
- Kseniia (is my name)
- i graduated from GSE last year
- i am doing my PhD now (it's game-related!)
- i have a (mostly) technical background
- ...but (somehow) i will teach Representation and Configuration next semester
- Oh I started Games Intersectional Roundtable. I guess that's why I'm here.
Thanks for having me!



Intersectionality and Video Games

- theoretical framework that helps us understand how different aspects of a person's identity—such as race, gender, class, sexuality, and disability— intersect in complex ways
- term was originally coined by scholar Kimberlé Crenshaw in the late 1980s to describe the experiences of African American women who face overlapping systems of discrimination
- In the context of video games, intersectionality is important for understanding how different players might experience the same game in different ways based on their intersecting identities. It also guides developers in creating more inclusive and representative games that acknowledge and respect these diverse experiences.



What is Intersectionality?

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Why do we talk about Intersectionality in Games?



Games as Safe Spaces for People with Intersectional Identities

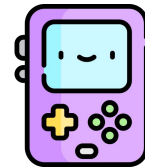
- In general people want to be understood, seen and feel safe.
- The more different you feel, the harder it is to fulfill these needs.
- Games create safe spaces for us to fulfill these needs (even if it's otherwise impossible)



Explicit VS Implicit Representation



Why do people get so angry?



Is it me or Sony be making their lead female protagonist look masculine as hell..barely no curves or rough non feminine features..Unlike the average woman. Like *cough cough..TLOU2's Ellie...etc. Just saying [#My2cents](#)

Pic from the game on the left, fan made on right. Hire fans lol

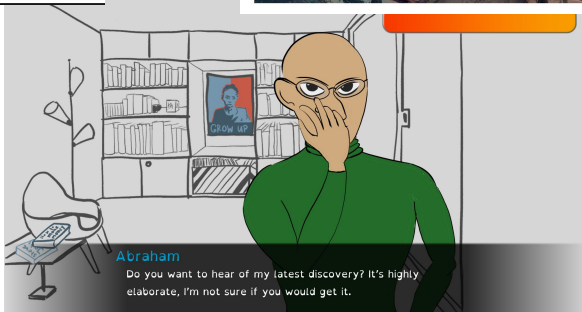
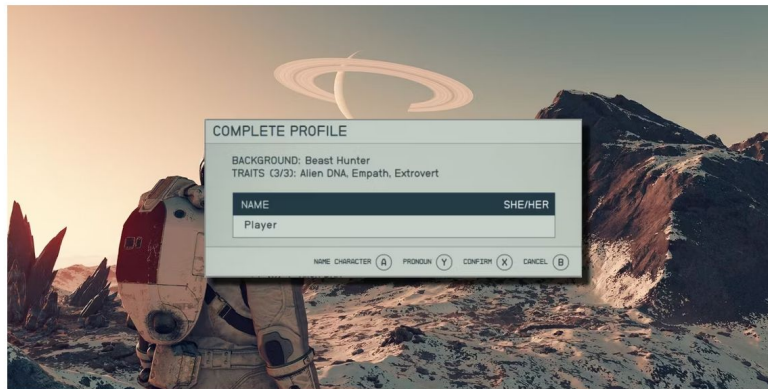


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Starfield's Pronoun 'Controversy' Explained

Starfield is stirring up a big controversy due to how it allows players to choose their character's pronouns, even resulting in refunds.

BY ANDREA TRAMA
PUBLISHED SEP 6, 2023



Abraham

Do you want to hear of my latest discovery? It's highly elaborate, I'm not sure if you would get it.

itch.io, Creativity and Economic Disparities in Gaming



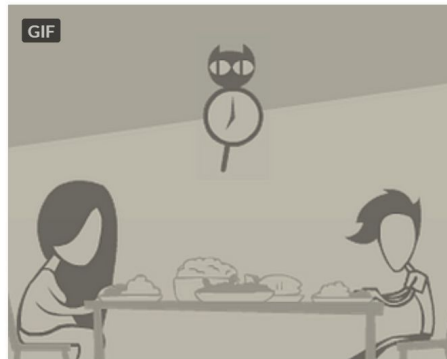
Adventures With Anxiety!

An interactive story about anxiety. You play *as* the anxiety



Tavern Talk

A Cozy Visual Novel Game



Coming Out Simulator 2014

a half-true story about half-truths

Questioning Video Game Narratives and Mechanics: Colonialism, Animal Expendability, Migration and Citizenship

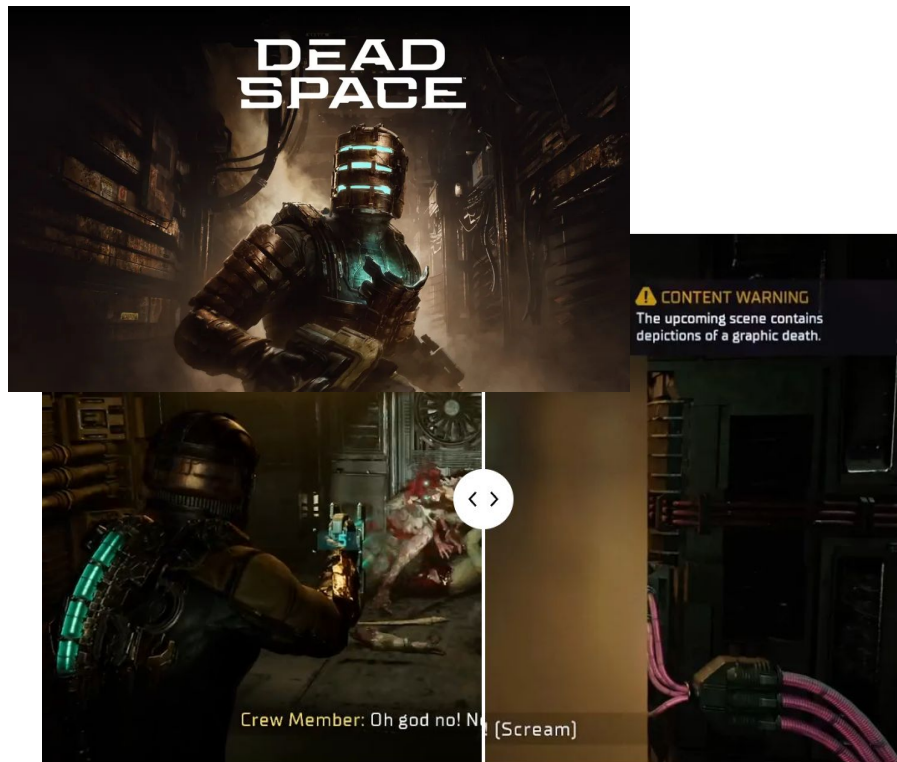
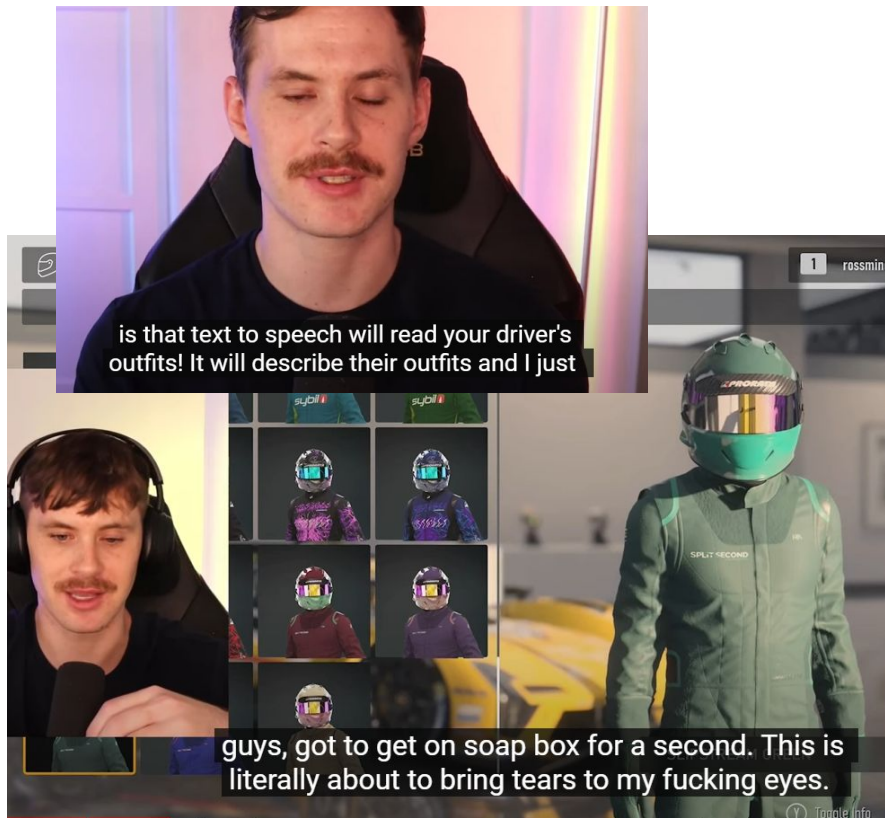




Importance of Accessibility Awareness in Games



Accessibility in 2023 Games



The same scene without and with Hide Disturbing Scenes enabled



We talked about intersectionality in games! Takeaways?

- ...
- ...
- ...





Thank you all for listening!

